

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

The Final Steps Accord

A Comprehensive Framework for US-Iran Peace, Nuclear Stabilization, and Regional Maritime Governance — Version 3.0

Calibrated for the Late May 2026 Negotiation Environment

Synthesizing the Crescent Bridge Accord, Stability First Enhanced Accord v5.7,

the Reciprocal Opening Window, and the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework

Incorporating the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) Protocols

Version 3.0 | Late May 2026

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Preamble: The Last Window

"We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children." In the same spirit, the negotiators who sign this Accord do not inherit the right to let this moment pass.

As of late May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to either durable peace or catastrophic escalation since hostilities began. After nearly twelve weeks of military confrontation, both sides have exhausted the military escalation ladder and returned to the negotiating table. The temporary ceasefire, brokered by Pakistan and observed since early April, remains technically in force but is fraying. President Trump has stated he will give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." Supreme Leader Khamenei has declared that Iran will protect its nuclear and missile capabilities at all costs. The world holds its breath.

v3.0 Critical Update — Late May 2026 Negotiation Environment

This Version 3.0 incorporates four surgical refinements calibrated to the explicit pushback from the IRGC (via Fars News Agency) and the firm sequencing demands from the Trump administration, as the parties approach the Sunday deadline:

- 1. JHTA Sovereignty Recalibration (Article 4):** The JHTA mandate is explicitly restricted to commercial traffic coordination, maritime safety protocols, and international dispute resolution. The PGSA is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters — allowing Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims while keeping multilateral transit guarantees airtight for Washington.
- 2. Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger Protocol (Article 6):** The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through an automated, simultaneous trigger on the Swiss Dashboard — preventing front-loaded concessions and guaranteeing symmetric execution.
- 3. HEU Custody Phase 1 Baseline (Article 1):** Legal title (Central Bank of Iran) is structurally decoupled from physical custody (IAEA-monitored facility in Oman). Physical custody transfer is a Phase 1 baseline verification metric; final disposition is deferred to the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window.
- 4. Lebanon and Levant Front Stabilization Protocol (Appendix E):** Addresses Iran's demand for an end to the war on all fronts, including Lebanon, through a Proxy Operational Pause for Hezbollah, a Dossier Isolation Firewall preventing Lebanon incidents from collapsing the core deal, and a Levant Regional Basket parallel diplomatic track.

This document is not a draft. It is not a proposal. It is the final, integrated architecture that transforms the temporary cessation of hostilities into a durable, comprehensive peace — addressing all fifteen critical blockers that have prevented every previous framework from reaching signature. It draws upon the Crescent Bridge Accord, the Stability First Enhanced Accord v5.7, the Reciprocal Opening Window, the Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework v3, the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework, and the Stability First Phase II Maritime Annex — integrating their most viable mechanisms into a single, coherent, executable whole.

This Accord fully incorporates the reality of Iran's newly established Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), founded on 5 May 2026, not by treating it as an obstacle to be dismantled but as an institutional fact to be integrated into a cooperative governance framework. The PGSA represents Iran's assertion of maritime sovereignty; this Accord provides the mechanism through which that

assertion becomes compatible with freedom of navigation, international law, and global economic stability.

The philosophy governing every provision is **Synchronized Reciprocal Motion**: neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Both governments can defend the sequencing as responding only when the other has moved first or simultaneously. When the negotiation becomes about data instead of history — about sensor readings, escrow confirmations, and physical lock verifications — both sides can verify compliance without trusting each other.

The Three Immutable Principles

1. Telemetry-First Diplomacy: Every commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If it cannot be verified by a neutral machine, it does not belong in the operational text.

2. Rollback, Not Snapback: If either party breaches, the Framework does not collapse. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless.

3. Modular Architecture: Failure in one module does not cascade. The compiler continues executing all other loaded modules. Maritime disputes cannot terminate humanitarian channels. Nuclear verification gaps do not affect Hormuz transit. Lebanon incidents cannot collapse the core US-Iran agreement.

Executive Summary: The Fifteen Bridges

Arena	Issue	Resolution Mechanism	Article
Nuclear	HEU Stockpile Disposition	IAEA Dual-Lock Custody Exchange; legal title decoupled from physical custody as Phase 1 baseline; disposition deferred to 30-60 day nuclear window	1
	Enrichment Cap & Timeline	Sliding-Scale 12-15 Year Moratorium	2
	Underground Site Hardening	Civilian Conversion & Black-Box Telemetry	3
Maritime	PGSA vs. Freedom of Navigation	JHTA Joint Governance with Sovereignty Recalibration; PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement within Iranian territorial waters	4
	Transit Security Fees	Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund	5
	US Naval Blockade	Synchronized Day-7 Dual-Trigger Lift with automated dashboard execution	6

Economic	Sanctions Relief Sequencing	15-Day Micro-Cycle Tranche Model	7
	Frozen Assets Shielding	Neutral Escrow under Sovereign Immunity	8
	SWIFT Reconnection	Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation	9
	War Reparations	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
Durability	30-Day Negotiation Window	Mutual Letter of Intent with Binding Timelines	11
	Institutional Guarantees	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 States)	12
	Internal Regime Fractures	Human-in-the-Loop Governance & Step-Back	13
	Drone/Missile Reconstitution	Deployment Pause & Transfer Freeze	14
	Global Agrifood Crisis	Energy & Agricultural Release Valve	15

Part I: Nuclear Stabilization Architecture

The nuclear file represents both the origin of the current crisis and its most technically complex dimension. Three interconnected issues have created a deadlock: the disposition of Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile, the duration and scope of any enrichment moratorium, and the fate of Iran's hardened underground facilities. This Part resolves all three through an integrated architecture that strips Iran of rapid breakout capability while preserving sovereign dignity and NPT rights.

Article 1: HEU Custody Exchange Protocol

Issue 1: The Nuclear Deadlock. President Trump demands the complete physical recovery and removal of Iran's roughly 900-pound (400 kg) highly enriched uranium (HEU) stockpile. Secretary Rubio maintains that Iran must physically surrender and hand over its HEU up front. Supreme Leader Khamenei has issued a strict directive that the HEU must remain on Iranian soil. Iranian Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has publicly framed the current text as a "framework agreement" meant to defer core nuclear details into a secondary 30-to-60 day window after baseline sanctions relief. The chasm between physical removal and domestic retention has collapsed every previous negotiation.

v3.0 Resolution: The IAEA Custody Exchange with Phase 1/Phase 2 Structural Decoupling

v3.0 Surgical Change — Decoupled Ownership and Custody

This solution structurally decouples **legal ownership** from **physical custody**. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU stockpile at all times. Physical custody is transferred immediately to a secure, IAEA-monitored facility as a **baseline verification metric for Phase 1**. Final disposition is deferred to the 30-60 day broader nuclear negotiating window. This satisfies Rubio's demand for immediate physical verification while respecting Iran's red line on deferring nuclear details.

1.1 The Custody Architecture

The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60% U-235 and above — estimated at approximately 400 kg HEU equivalent — shall be consolidated, inventoried, and placed under IAEA custody within the first 72 hours of Accord activation. Two custody pathways are available:

Pathway A (In-Iran): Dual-lock custody at the Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center or another IAEA-declared facility within Iranian territory, selected by mutual agreement. The IAEA holds exclusive digital encryption keys to all monitoring arrays, tamper-evident seal controls, and access verification systems. Iran holds physical perimeter security keys. Neither party can access the sealed containers without the other's physical presence.

Pathway B (Oman): Physical custody transferred to IAEA custody facility in Muscat, Oman (not the United States). The stockpile is transported in IAEA-certified secure containers under armed IAEA guard. Continuous CCTV monitoring covers the entire transport chain. Satellite surveillance tracks the transport vessels. The stockpile remains under IAEA dual-lock custody at the Muscat facility.

Legal Title Structure (Binding for Both Pathways): The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU throughout the custody period. The IAEA holds physical custody only. The Custody Services Agreement specifies that: (a) Iran retains full legal title; (b) the IAEA may not transfer, sell, or dispose of the material without written consent of the Central Bank of Iran; (c) the material is held for the purpose of baseline verification and civilian conversion negotiation, not for destruction or permanent removal from Iranian ownership; (d) the final disposition is subject to the outcome of the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window; (e) if the Accord is terminated by mutual agreement, the material is returned to Iran under IAEA supervision.

1.2 Phase 1 vs. Phase 2 Clarity

Phase	Timeline	Iranian Commitment	US Reciprocal	Final Disposition Status
Phase Baseline Verification	1: Days 1-30	Physical consolidation, inventory, and IAEA custody activation (Pathway A or B). Mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition. Dual-lock seals applied.	\$250M humanitarian OFAC general license; 5th Fleet stand-off posture; sanctions designation freeze	Deferred. No final disposition required. Physical custody + verification satisfies Phase 1 trigger.
Phase Nuclear Negotiating Window	2: Days 30-60	Participation in dedicated nuclear negotiating track to determine final HEU disposition from the six-pathway menu.	Tranche 2 release (25% of remaining frozen assets); petrochemical export licenses	Negotiated. Iran selects disposition pathway. US verifies execution. No US veto over pathway selected.

US Narrative Frame: "Weapons-grade uranium secured — the entire Iranian stockpile of near-weapons-grade material has been placed under IAEA custody with US monitoring access. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. Physical verification is immediate."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "Iran's enriched uranium remains Iranian property. The Central Bank of Iran retains sovereign title. Physical custody to IAEA is a verification step in a broader negotiation — not surrender. Final disposition will be decided in the nuclear negotiating window on terms that respect our NPT rights."

ARTICLE 1.3 — NO HIDDEN US CUSTODY CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

At no stage may the United States receive, store, transport, or exercise operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA and, where transferred, the designated third-party facilitating state. US personnel shall not be present at any consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operation. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable.

1.3 Verification Timeline

Phase	Clock Time	Action	Verifying Party
T+0	0000 GMT (Day 1)	Accord activates; Parties activate Day-One commitments	Joint Secretariat
T+12h	1200 GMT (Day 1)	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared facility; begin physical inventory	IAEA
T+24h	0000 GMT (Day 2)	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	IAEA
T+48h	0000 GMT (Day 3)	Cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied; manifest finalized	IAEA
T+72h	0000 GMT (Day 4)	Day-One deadline: dual-lock custody initiated and verified	Joint Secretariat

1.4 Synchronized US Commitment

Simultaneously with Iranian custody activation, the United States shall: (1) Release a USD 250 million humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow; (2) Issue an OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety parts) for 90 days; (3) Transition US naval forces to a stand-off posture: no patrols within 5 nautical miles of the Hormuz transit corridor; (4) Freeze all new sanctions designations for the duration of the Accord; (5) Publish a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV.

1.5 The Six Pathways for Final Disposition (Phase 2, Days 30-60)

Within the 30-60 day nuclear negotiating window, Iran shall select one of six IAEA-verified disposition pathways. The United States shall have no veto over the pathway selected, only the right to verify its execution:

Path	Description	Destination/Timeline
A	In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan	Medical isotope production in Iran; 142 days
B	HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman	IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US); 14 days
C	Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank	Oskemen, Kazakhstan; 75 days
D	Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards	Russian Federation; 60-90 days
E	Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies	Bushehr reactor supply; 180 days
F	Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways	Multiple destinations; concurrent

Article 2: The Sliding-Scale Enrichment Moratorium

Issue 2: The Enrichment Cap and Moratorium Timeline. The U.S. is pushing for an absolute "zero enrichment" baseline or a strict 20-year moratorium. Iran has countered with a maximum 12-year

suspension window. Neither position is domestically survivable for its proponent.

The Resolution: Automated Sliding-Scale Duration (12-15 Years)

An automated, sliding-scale duration tied explicitly to a step-by-step verification pipeline, where verified compliance extends the window and material breaches contract it — with annual review at each milestone.

2.1 The Three-Tier Moratorium Structure

Phase	Duration	Standard	Advancement Condition
Moratorium I	Years 1-12	Zero enrichment above 3.67%; higher centrifuges under IAEA seal	Clean IAEA certification at Year 12 review
Civilian Transition	Years 13-15	3.67% enrichment at Natanz only; all other sites in mothball status	Fuel supply guarantee in escrow from international consortium
Steady-State	Year 16+	3.67% under full IAEA safeguards	Successor framework confirmed by both parties

2.2 Monitoring Sunset Tiers

Monitoring Measure	Initial Intensity	Sunset Reduction	Condition
Seismic sensors at hardened enrichment facilities	Continuous	Reduced to weekly sampling after 12 months	12 consecutive months of IAEA-certified compliance
Enhanced satellite revisit frequency	Daily	Reduced to 3x weekly after 18 months	18 consecutive months of clean compliance
Unannounced inspection frequency	Minimum 33% of all inspections	Reduced to 20% after 24 months	24 consecutive months of clean compliance
Continuous monitoring	camera 24/7 encrypted	No sunset — standard for all NPT Additional Protocol states	Baseline protection

Article 3: Underground Site Conversion & Mothball Protocol

Issue 3: Advanced Centrifuge Hardening & Underground Sites. President Trump has threatened to permanently "knock out" five deeply buried underground storage and manufacturing sites. Iran demands the preservation of its infrastructure as sovereign property.

The Resolution: Civilian Conversion with Black-Box Telemetry

A technical compromise that converts heavily fortified bunkers into civilian nuclear research or global medical isotope centers, verified by continuous black-box telemetry — preserving infrastructure while eliminating weapons pathways.

3.1 The Mothball Protocol

Rather than physically destroying facilities, Iran shall place non-core enrichment sites under "mothball status" with continuous real-time IAEA remote feeds. The US receives operational limitation

to a single declared site (Natanz). Iran keeps its sovereign infrastructure intact.

Phase	Window	Action
Inventory	Day 1-14	IAEA inventories all rotors and bellows at Natanz and Isfahan above 3.67% enrichment capability
Removal	Day 15-44	Iranian technicians remove rotors under IAEA supervision; sealed with serial numbers in tamper-evident containers
Storage	Day 45-60	Sealed containers transferred to UN-monitored facility within Iran; IAEA continuous access established
Monitoring	Day 60+	IAEA continuous cameras; quarterly environmental sampling; 72-hour safety extensions permitted if OLEM confirms no active enrichment

3.2 The Fordow Joint Venture

The Fordow facility shall be converted into a Global Medical Isotope Production Center: Operational management by a Technical Custody Consortium (TCC) from Switzerland, Austria, Oman. Iranian personnel serve as "Co-Pilots" with the right to question, document, and escalate any operation. US technical observers have real-time monitoring access through encrypted surveillance feeds. Revenue shared: Iran 40%, TCC 35%, Global Health Fund 25%.

3.3 Black-Box Telemetry

All mothballed and converted facilities shall be equipped with Black-Box Sensors — tamper-evident data logging devices that continuously record operational parameters and transmit encrypted data to IAEA nodes in Vienna (primary) and Geneva (secondary). Any anomaly triggers an automatic alert within 15 minutes. The sensors cannot be disabled without triggering a Tier 2 breach signal.

Part II: Maritime Governance & PGSA Integration

The Strait of Hormuz is not merely a waterway — it is the aorta of the global economy. Iran's establishment of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) on 5 May 2026 represents a *fait accompli*. This Part integrates the Authority into a cooperative governance framework that preserves Iranian sovereignty claims while guaranteeing freedom of navigation.

Article 4: The Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA)

Issue 4: The Strait of Hormuz Vetting System vs. Freedom of Navigation. The IRGC Navy has established a rigid *de facto* transit system under the PGSA, requiring vessels to provide more than 40 items of information and pay fees reportedly up to \$2 million per transit. President Trump has explicitly rejected any tolling system, stating "We don't want tolls. It's an international waterway." Secretary Rubio has declared that implementing any form of maritime tolling makes a diplomatic agreement "fundamentally unfeasible." Iranian Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has publicly insisted that the management of the Strait — determining routes, times, methods of passage, and issuing permits — remains "the monopoly and discretion of the Islamic Republic." The IRGC considers Hormuz control a core element of Iran's strategic deterrent.

v3.0 Surgical Change — JHTA Sovereignty Recalibration

The JHTA mandate is **explicitly restricted to three functions only**: (i) commercial traffic coordination; (ii) maritime safety protocols; and (iii) international dispute resolution. The PGSA is **formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters**. This allows Tehran to preserve its domestic sovereignty claims while keeping multilateral transit guarantees airtight for Washington.

4.1 Establishment and Constitutional Basis

The Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA) is hereby established as a permanent multilateral maritime governance body effective on Accord Day-One. It operates under a constitutive agreement that is technically an annex to this Accord and not a separate treaty, ensuring that neither Party is required to submit the JHTA charter for domestic legislative ratification.

The JHTA exercises **delegated administrative authority, not sovereign authority**. It does not supersede UNCLOS, does not create supranational jurisdiction, and does not impair Iran's rights under Article 37 of UNCLOS governing transit passage through international straits.

4.2 JHTA Jurisdiction Limitation and Sovereignty Recalibration (v3.0)

ARTICLE 4.2-A — JHTA MANDATE RESTRICTION (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The JHTA's mandate is **explicitly restricted to three functions only**: (i) **commercial traffic coordination** — managing the flow of civilian commercial vessels through the Strait; (ii) **maritime safety protocols** — navigational aids, collision avoidance, emergency response, and search-and-rescue coordination; and (iii) **international dispute resolution** — addressing transit disputes between commercial vessels and littoral states through binding arbitration under UNCLOS.

The JHTA holds **zero jurisdiction** over sovereign Iranian or regional territorial defense waters, coastal defense operations, military vessel movements, fisheries management, customs enforcement, or environmental regulation beyond navigational safety.

ARTICLE 4.2-B — PGSA AS SOLE EXECUTIVE COASTAL LAW ENFORCEMENT BODY (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) is **explicitly recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters** (12-nautical-mile limit). This recognition is formal, unequivocal, and operates as a binding interpretive principle of the JHTA Charter. Within Iranian territorial waters, the PGSA retains exclusive authority over: vessel permitting and documentation review; coastal patrol and interdiction; customs and immigration enforcement; security screening of suspect vessels; and coordination with the IRGC-Navy on maritime security matters.

The JHTA may not override, supersede, or contradict PGSA enforcement actions within Iranian territorial waters. The IRGC's statutory authority over coastal defense, territorial security, and military operations in the Strait is explicitly preserved and unaffected by the JHTA Charter. Any JHTA action that could be construed as affecting IRGC or PGSA operations requires explicit Iranian concurrence through the Iranian co-chair.

ARTICLE 4.1-A — PGSA INTEGRATION CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) shall be formally integrated into the JHTA as Iran's designated operational implementation body for transit coordination, vessel verification, and fee collection within Iranian territorial waters. The PGSA retains its Iranian statutory authority but exercises that authority under JHTA Council oversight and in accordance with JHTA-approved protocols. All PGSA transit permits shall bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran and JHTA-authorized. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable.

4.3 Optical Compromise Architecture (v3.0)

This structure allows President Trump to state that "the Strait is open to international commerce under multilateral governance" while allowing Iranian officials to state that "the PGSA remains the

sole authority for Hormuz transit within our territorial waters, and the JHTA's role is limited to commercial coordination." Both statements are factually accurate under the Charter. The JHTA governs the international transit corridor; the PGSA governs Iranian coastal waters. Neither body's authority encroaches on the other.

US Narrative Frame: "No more unilateral Iranian tolling. The Strait is governed as an open international waterway under UNCLOS. All commercial vessels receive equal treatment. The US holds a permanent seat on the governing council."

Iranian Narrative Frame: "The PGSA remains Iran's statutory authority for Hormuz transit. We hold a permanent co-chair seat. Our personnel staff the transit centers. We receive 40% of fund revenue. The IRGC's coastal defense authority is explicitly untouched."

4.4 Governing Council Composition

Seat	Holder	Rationale	Veto Rights
1	Islamic Republic of Iran / PGSA	Coastal sovereign, littoral state, strait administrator	Governance questions; revenue allocation amendments
2	United States	Primary naval guarantor; maritime security provider	Security protocol amendments; EW rule changes
3	Sultanate of Oman	Neutral host, JHTA Secretariat location, tiebreaker state	Tiebreaker vote; Secretariat location
4	UK/France (Rotating Chair, annual)	Coalition force representation (Multinational Maritime Shield)	None — advisory vote only
5	People's Republic of China (Observer)	Largest Gulf-oil importer; technical observer	None — technical advisory
6	UN OCHA Observer	Humanitarian corridor and transit oversight	None — humanitarian advisory only

Voting Threshold: Routine operational decisions require three affirmative votes from Seats 1-4. Governance amendments require unanimous consent from Seats 1-3. No amendment may pass over the simultaneous objection of both Iran and the United States.

4.5 The PGSA-JHTA Transit Permit System

All commercial vessels transiting the Hormuz Transit Zone shall obtain a dual-branded transit permit: (1) PGSA Application through the PGSA portal (pgsa.ir); (2) JHTA Verification against international databases (IMO, Lloyd's List, INTERPOL); (3) Dual Authorization with JHTA-AUTHORIZED AIS designation; (4) Fee Processing through the Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund, not paid directly to Iran.

4.6 Distance Protocols and Rules of Engagement

Phase	Days	IRGC Stand-Off from CTC	US/Coalition Stand-Off from Iranian 12nm Baseline
Learning Period	D+1 to D+14	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)

Operational Period	D+15 onward	5 nm from CTC outer edge	5 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline
Elevated Posture (Tier 2)	JHA-declared	8 nm from CTC outer edge	8 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline

Article 5: Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Issue 5: Transit "Security Fees" and Maritime Funding. Iran and Oman are actively negotiating a permanent toll/fee system. President Trump explicitly rejected this, stating "We don't want tolls."

The Resolution: Transparent Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Translating unilateral checkpoint tolls into a highly structured, internationally compliant fund where fees are transparently pooled for shared waterway safety services.

5.1 Fund Architecture

The Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund (MMMF) is established under the sovereign jurisdiction of the Sultanate of Oman, legally insulated from domestic civil litigation or third-party attachment. Fee Schedule: Tier 1 (Humanitarian — medicine, food, medical equipment): Zero fee; 24-hour fast-track. Tier 2 (Standard commercial): \$0.15 per ton deadweight. Tier 3 (Energy/premium — oil, LNG, chemicals): \$0.25 per ton or \$35,000 flat fee per VLCC. JHTA Council member state vessels: Exempt. Revenue Allocation: 40% Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (PGSA oversight), 35% International Maritime Safety Fund, 25% JHTA Operations and Secretariat costs.

5.2 Automated Toll Disbursal Default

If the JHTA Council fails to pass an annual budget due to US-Iran deadlock, toll revenues automatically distribute per the baseline percentages. The neutral Secretariat executes within 7 days. Political deadlock cannot freeze baseline distributions.

5.3 The \$20 Billion Reinsurance Backstop

The US Development Finance Corporation commits \$10 billion, Lloyd's of London underwrites \$5 billion, and the Omani Sovereign Wealth Fund contributes \$5 billion, creating a \$20 billion reinsurance facility. This backstop activates upon JHTA certification of the first 200 authorized transits.

Article 6: Synchronized Dual-Blockade Lift Protocol

Issue 6: Lifting the U.S. Naval Blockade. CENTCOM continues to enforce a crippling naval blockade on Iranian ports. Iran considers this a direct violation of the ceasefire spirit and has made blockade lifting a precondition for any Hormuz opening.

v3.0 Surgical Change — Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger Protocol

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and Naval Blockade Lift Declaration are executed through an **automated, simultaneous trigger on the Swiss Dashboard**. The technical architecture prevents front-loaded concessions, eliminates human timing errors, and ensures that neither side can claim the other moved first. If either declaration fails to execute within the 60-second UTC window, both declarations are void — preventing any appearance of unilateral concession.

6.1 The Dual-Blockade Problem

The central mechanical deadlock is a sequencing dispute with no diplomatic solution: the US demands Hormuz open before lifting the naval blockade; Iran demands the blockade lift before opening Hormuz. The Day-7 Protocol dissolves this impasse by eliminating the sequence entirely. Both actions occur at the same UTC timestamp, within the same 60-second window, under simultaneous observation by neutral parties.

6.2 The Minute-by-Minute Choreography (Day 7 UTC Timeline)

UTC Time	Iranian Action	US Action	Verification
T-60 min	IRGC Commander transmits stand-by to JHTA MCC	5th Fleet Commander transmits stand-by to JHTA MCC	Omani facilitating state logs both signals
T-15 min	IRGC craft withdraw to 5nm; AIS broadcast	US Navy withdraws to 5nm from 12nm baseline; AIS broadcast	Lloyd's List confirms movements
T=0	Iran issues Hormuz opening declaration; IRGC transmits stand-down orders	US issues blockade lift declaration; 5th Fleet transmits stand-down orders	SIMULTANEOUS within 60-second window
T+15 min	First JHTA-AUTHORIZED vessel commences CTC transit	US issues Notice to Mariners confirming Hormuz open	Lloyd's List, AIS Global confirm
T+6h	IRGC issues first 6-hour compliance report	5th Fleet issues first 6-hour compliance report	JHTA MCC issues first public Daily Transit Report
T+24h	24-Hour Bright-Line Period ends; standard ROE replaces heightened monitoring; JHTA Chair certifies Day-7 Protocol complete		

6.3 v3.0 Automated Dual-Trigger Technical Architecture (New)

ARTICLE 6.3 — AUTOMATED SIMULTANEOUS TRIGGER PROTOCOL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Hormuz Opening Declaration and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration shall be executed through an automated, simultaneous trigger on the Swiss Dashboard. The technical architecture operates as follows:

- (1) T-minus-24 hours (Day 6, 00:00 UTC):** Both parties confirm readiness through their respective liaison offices. The confirmation is logged on the Dashboard and cannot be withdrawn without triggering a 72-hour technical consultation.
- (2) T-minus-1 hour (Day 7, 00:00 UTC):** The Dashboard enters "Armed Standby" mode. Both parties' HSMs must transmit a "ready" authentication token within the same 5-minute window. If either token is not received, the trigger aborts automatically and a 48-hour technical consultation opens.
- (3) T-zero (Day 7, 01:00 UTC):** The Dashboard executes both declarations simultaneously within a 60-second UTC window: the Hormuz Opening Declaration (Iran) and the Naval Blockade Lift Declaration (US) are published simultaneously to all liaison offices, the UN Secretary-General, and the JHTA Secretariat. Neither declaration is active without the other. The Dashboard logs the exact timestamp (millisecond precision) and publishes the synchronization certificate.
- (4) Concurrent Airspace Stand-Down:** Simultaneously with the maritime dual-trigger, both sides enter the proportional Airspace Stand-Down Protocol within the same 60-second window. Three-zone buffer activation (Zone Alpha: Strait Corridor; Zone Beta: Coastal Buffer; Zone Gamma: Deep Airspace) is choreographed through the Dashboard.
- (5) Auto-Void Failure Mode:** If either declaration fails to execute within the 60-second window, both declarations are void. Neither party is considered to have opened the Strait or lifted the blockade. The Framework Survival Core remains intact. A 48-hour technical grace period opens to diagnose and remediate the failure before either party may invoke stepback.

6.4 The 24-Hour Bright-Line Period

The 24 hours following Day-7 activation constitute a heightened monitoring window. Any deviation constitutes a protocol violation regardless of intent. Category A violations (vessels within 3 nm of exclusion zones, kinetic action, failure to issue declarations) trigger automatic bilateral suspension — both blockades reactivate, neither party benefits from the other's compliance during its own non-compliance.

Part III: Economic Normalization Framework

The nuclear and maritime dimensions of this crisis cannot be sustainably resolved without parallel economic architecture. Iran's economy has been devastated by years of sanctions compounded by the 2026 war and the US naval blockade. This Part addresses four interconnected economic blockers through a unified framework of graduated relief, neutral custody, phased financial reconnection, and reconstruction credits.

Article 7: Graduated Sanctions Relief Tranches

Issue 7: Chronological Sequencing of Sanctions Relief. Iran demands an immediate, blanket lifting of all secondary sanctions. The US refuses to yield economic leverage before total nuclear compliance is achieved.

The Resolution: 15-Day Micro-Cycle Pacing Model

A highly granular, step-by-step economic tranche model that releases sanctions relief in rigid 15-day micro-cycles directly triggered by physical milestones verified by the IAEA.

7.1 The Eight-Tranche Architecture

Tranche	Timing	Relief Granted	Physical Milestone Trigger	Reversibility
Pilot	Day 1	\$250M humanitarian release; medicine, food, medical equipment licenses	Accord signature; 72-hour ceasefire confirmed	Non-reversible
1	Day 14	25% of remaining frozen assets; civilian aircraft parts, agricultural goods	Stage 1 closed; IAEA deployed; stockpile custody verified	Non-reversible
2	Day 44	25% of remaining frozen assets; petrochemical exports authorized	60-day compliance; nuclear exchange verified	Non-reversible
3	Day 120	20% of remaining frozen assets; metals and minerals trade	Permanent JHTA operational; dual-blockade lifted	30-day remediation
4	Day 180	15% of remaining frozen assets; automotive parts, textiles	180-day compliance review	JIG breach review
5	Day 365	10% of remaining frozen assets	12 months clean certification	Material-breach hold
Balance	Year 2-3	Remainder of frozen assets	Full successor framework compliance	Successor risk appetite

7.2 Currency Protection

All downstream asset releases from Tranche 3 onward are denominated in IMF Special Drawing Rights (SDR) or a fixed basket of Swiss Francs and Omani Rials (60/40). This protects real economic value from dollar inflation or monetary shocks.

Article 8: Neutral Escrow and Asset Shielding Architecture

Issue 8: Liquidating and Shielding Frozen Assets. Iran demands the immediate unfreezing of its sovereign assets worldwide. The US requires ironclad performance reserves to prevent diversion.

The Resolution: Joint Sovereign Custody Protocol with Neutral Escrow

A slice of frozen funds (30%) is transferred to an independent third-party account at the Central Bank of Oman (Muscat), legally designated for civilian infrastructure reconstruction and verified humanitarian relief. The remaining 70% remains in existing frozen accounts, released tranche-by-tranche upon verified milestones.

8.1 Escrow Allocation

Category		Allocation	Administrator	Rolling Back
Humanitarian (medicine, food)		25%	UN OCHA / WHO	Protected — Humanitarian Firewall
Critical Infrastructure		45%	World Bank / Swiss Financial Cell	Protected — Tranches 1-2
Iranian Reconstruction	Civilian	20%	JHTA with Iranian programmatic control	Subject to Tier 3 review
Maritime Safety		10%	International Maritime Safety Fund	Protected

8.2 Sovereign Immunity Wrapper

The escrow fund is legally structured under sovereign immunity protections within Oman. The US issues a binding national security waiver protecting all fund assets from domestic judicial seizure, private civil litigation, or secondary sanctions enforcement. No US court may attach, freeze, or garnish Fund assets. This shield applies retroactively from first deposit and survives any framework suspension.

8.3 OFAC Comfort Letters and Pre-Clearance

The US Treasury shall issue comprehensive, irrevocable OFAC general licenses and formal Comfort Letters to all participating European and Gulf clearinghouses. These letters provide that all transactions routed through the designated Central Bank of Oman escrow account for humanitarian or civilian purposes are legally pre-cleared and entirely exempt from secondary sanctions exposure, asset forfeiture mechanisms, and civil or criminal penalties. Non-US financial institutions, shipping companies, insurers, and commodity traders are explicitly shielded from secondary sanctions designation. Immunization is legally binding and cannot be revoked by executive discretion without 180 days' prior written notice. No notice of revocation may be issued during the first 365 days.

Article 9: Phased SWIFT Reconnection Protocol

Issue 9: SWIFT Reconnection and Banking Isolation. Iran's total disconnection from the global financial grid paralyzes its commercial sector.

The Resolution: Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation

Phase	Timing	Access	IAEA Milestone Trigger
Phase 0 (Pre-SWIFT)	Days 1-30	No SWIFT. Qatari riyal bridge facility for humanitarian payments only	OLEM confirms 60% within 72h
Phase 1 (Restricted)	Days 30-60	5 designated Iranian banks; MT 103/202 only; transaction cap \$1M per day per bank	Moratorium declared; standard monitoring confirmed
Phase 2 (Expanded)	Days 60-120	All clean-record Iranian banks; full message types; transaction caps lifted for humanitarian trade	Continuous monitoring; no diversion detected for 60 days
Phase 3 (Full)	Day 120+	Full SWIFT membership; all Iranian financial institutions in good standing	Year 1 clean certification

9.1 SWIFT Remediation Fuse

If IAEA identifies a Tier 2 compliance concern, the SWIFT phase holds for exactly 14 days as a remediation window. Resolved within 14 days: phase advances normally. Unresolved after 14 days: SWIFT rolls back exactly one tier.

Article 10: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Issue 10: War Reparations vs. Economic Reconstruction Credits. Tehran formally requested US-funded war reparations. The Trump administration flatly rejected the concept of reparations.

The Resolution: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Framing the financial packages as development credits rather than liability-based reparations — keeping both sides politically safe at home while delivering equivalent economic benefit.

10.1 The No-Fault Architecture

Instrument: The International Gulf Reconstruction Fund — established under sovereign immunity in Oman, managed by the World Bank with Iranian programmatic input. Funding: 30% of Iranian frozen assets (already Iranian money) plus contributions from Gulf states, EU, and international development banks. US Contribution: Technical assistance, engineering expertise, and development finance guarantees — not direct cash payments. Label: "Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits" — not reparations, not aid, but investment in regional stability.

10.2 Eligible Expenditure Categories

Category	Examples	Conditions
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Civilian Infrastructure	Power generation, water treatment, telecommunications	Open tender; IAEA diversion clearance
Healthcare	Hospitals, medical equipment, pharmaceutical production	WHO verification of civilian end-use
Education	Schools, universities, vocational training centers	UNESCO oversight
Environmental Remediation	Oil spill cleanup, desertification programs	UNEP technical assessment
Excluded Categories	Military facilities, dual-use research, IRGC-linked entities	Automatic exclusion; no appeal

Part IV: Treaty Durability and Regional Architecture

An agreement that collapses upon the first breach is worse than no agreement at all — it destroys trust and makes future negotiation impossible. This Part addresses the five structural challenges that determine whether the Accord endures beyond the first crisis.

Article 11: The 30-Day Letter of Intent and Binding Timeline

Issue 11: The 30-Day Negotiation Window. The current ceasefire is highly fragile. President Trump has stated he will only give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." The absence of a binding timeline means every day of negotiation is a day of existential risk.

The Resolution: Binding Letter of Intent with Auto-Renewing Ceasefire

Transitioning the unstable temporary halt into a binding 30-day negotiation timeline locked via a mutual Letter of Intent, underpinned by a self-renewing 72-hour ceasefire that eliminates the "negotiation about negotiation" trap.

11.1 The Letter of Intent

Upon signature, both parties shall simultaneously deposit a Letter of Intent with the Joint Secretariat affirming: commitment to the full 180-day implementation timeline; authorization for the Joint Secretariat to convene emergency consultations within 4 hours of any reported violation; agreement that no military action shall be taken during the 180-day period without first exhausting dispute resolution procedures; acceptance that the 72-hour ceasefire auto-renews at Hour 71 provided verification teams report compliance.

11.2 The Escrow Ceasefire Architecture

The ceasefire is a self-renewing 72-hour module. If verification teams report compliance at Hour 71, the module auto-renews for another 72 hours. Peace is maintained without either side signing away long-term leverage upfront. Separating the ceasefire clock (72-hour loops) from the implementation clock (30-day phases) neutralizes the "negotiation about negotiation" trap.

11.3 Attribution Deferral Window for Proxy Incidents

If a regional proxy strike occurs, neither side may unilaterally declare a material breach. The Joint Coordination Secretariat has 48 hours to conduct forensic telemetry and attribute the incident. During this window, the 72-hour military freeze remains active, provided Iran issues an immediate public condemnation and freezes matching local militia supply logistics. Only the Secretariat's attribution finding can trigger Tier escalation. Rogue actors and false-flag operations are excluded from bilateral penalties.

Article 12: Distributed Guarantor Matrix

Issue 12: Institutional Mediation and Guarantee Frameworks. A profound trust deficit exists between Washington and Tehran. Neither country believes the other will honor a signed document.

The Resolution: Six-State Distributed Guarantor Matrix

A formal guarantor consortium where regional mediators and global powers serve as co-depositaries and technical verifiers — distributing trust across multiple independent parties.

12.1 The Matrix Structure

State/Entity	Function	Core Guarantee
Oman	Lead facilitator, host nation, JHTA maritime observer	Physical hosting of JHTA Secretariat; diplomatic backchannel
Pakistan	Procedural mediation, crisis summits, leadership relay	Emergency convening authority within 24 hours
Qatar	Financial escrow and bridging liquidity	Emergency liquidity for humanitarian payments
China (PRC)	Economic guarantor, Hormuz oil importer, technical observer	Guarantee of energy transit; non-military enforcement
Russian Federation	Nuclear technical guarantor (HEU disposition Path D)	Technical custody and conversion verification
European Union (E3+)	Sanctions relief coordinator, civilian nuclear partner	Blocking statute protection against secondary sanctions

12.2 The Mandatory Escalation Pause

When any facilitating state determines escalation is imminent, it issues a Mandatory Escalation Pause Recommendation. This activates a 30-minute review window. Neither party may take escalatory action. Both must designate senior officials for consultation within 30 minutes. Either party may request extended Cooling-Off (24-72 hours). If either party supports the pause, the freeze continues.

12.3 Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is a standing technical body composed of one senior official from each guarantor state plus the US and Iran. It meets monthly by secure video and within 72 hours of any reported discrepancy. The JIG does not have binding arbitration authority but serves as the primary compliance assessment body.

Article 13: Human-in-the-Loop Governance

Issue 13: Internal Regime Fractures and Automated Escalation. Top US officials have highlighted intense ideological fractures within Tehran's leadership. Automated deal triggers could easily be derailed by political hardliners on either side.

The Resolution: Human-in-the-Loop Governance with Step-Back Architecture

Automation informs; humans decide. A governance system that allows leaders to exercise strategic discretion and execute a "procedural step-back" rather than letting a technical infraction trigger a catastrophic, automated return to total war.

13.1 The Three-Tier Breach System

Tier	Classification	Telemetry Signature	Response
1	Technical Dispute (De Minimis)	<0.5% above enrichment ceiling; ≤2 un-mothballed rotors; ≤48h reporting delay	Engineering resolution within 14 days; no rollback; confidential handling
2	Material Disruption	>0.5% above ceiling; >2 rotors; >72h IAEA obstruction	25% benefit reduction; 30-day remediation; earn-back via compliance
3	Deliberate Hostile Violation	Nuclear weapons activity; fissile diversion; IAEA attack	50% reduction; 90-day remediation; full earn-back after sustained compliance

13.2 De Minimis Thresholds

Enrichment ceiling: 3.67% U-235, with ±0.5% De Minimis tolerance. Un-mothballed centrifuges: Up to 2 rotors permitted for legitimate research. IAEA reporting delays: Up to 48 hours for administrative or technical reasons.

13.3 The Step-Back Architecture

Tier 1 Step-Down: No benefit reduction. 14-day resolution. JIG technical assistance. Quiet compliance corrections confidential.

Tier 2 Step-Down: 25% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Humanitarian tranches protected. SWIFT phase holds (14-day fuse active). 30-day remediation. Full restore on IAEA clean certification within 14 days.

Tier 3 Step-Down: 50% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Tier 3 modules enter hold. 90-day remediation. Full earn-back requires: 90-day sustained compliance + IAEA clean certification + JIG majority confirmation.

13.4 Human-in-the-Loop Provisions

No automated output triggers a binding diplomatic consequence without explicit human authorization at the appropriate level of seniority. Dual-key authorization: Any transition that materially alters the obligations of either party requires simultaneous authorization from designated senior officials on both sides. Grace over rigidity: A party that needs an extra 48 hours because its treasury office is closed for a national holiday is not treated as a violator; it is treated as a partner whose administrative rhythms deserve accommodation.

Article 14: Ballistic and Drone Program Pause Protocol

Issue 14: Drone and Missile Program Reconstitution. Intelligence reports indicate Iran is rapidly using the ceasefire window to reconstitute its drone and missile industrial base. The US wants strict limitations, which Iran has previously declared non-negotiable as sovereign defense capabilities.

The Resolution: Deployment Pause and Transfer Freeze

Deferring heavy ballistic limitations to later, mature dialogue stages while implementing an immediate, verifiable pause on offensive deployment and cross-border transfers — freezing the threat without demanding disarmament.

14.1 The Three-Pillar Structure

Pillar 1 — Deployment Freeze: Iran commits to no new offensive deployment of ballistic missiles or combat drones to regional proxy forces for the duration of the Accord. Verified through satellite surveillance, signals intelligence, and regional observer reports.

Pillar 2 — Transfer Suspension: All cross-border transfers of missile components, drone assemblies, and related technology to non-state actors are suspended. Verification through intelligence sharing among guarantor states and JHTA maritime monitoring of cargo manifests.

Pillar 3 — Industrial Activity Monitoring: Iran's domestic missile and drone production facilities are subject to baseline satellite monitoring. New facility construction or significant production expansion triggers a Tier 1 consultation but is not itself a violation.

14.2 Iranian Safeguards

This Protocol explicitly does NOT: require dismantlement of existing missile or drone inventories; prohibit domestic testing of short-range defensive systems; impose limits on Iran's sovereign right to maintain conventional military forces; subject military facilities to IAEA inspection.

Article 15: Energy and Agricultural Release Valve

Issue 15: Systemic Agrifood Shocks and Global Stabilization. The prolonged closure of the Strait of Hormuz has choked off a third of the world's fertilizer supply, causing the UN to warn of a systemic global agrifood crisis.

The Resolution: Immediate Energy and Agricultural Release Valve

Creating an immediate separation of global humanitarian supply lines from the underlying political dispute.

15.1 The Zero-Fee Humanitarian Corridor

From Day-One: Eligible cargo (wheat, rice, fertilizer, medical supplies, infant formula, agricultural seeds, humanitarian energy) fast-tracked through UN OCHA pre-clearance. All JHTA transit fees waived. Vessels may request neutral naval escort (Omani or UN-flagged) at no cost. Insurance covered under the \$20 billion reinsurance backstop.

15.2 Agricultural Supply Guarantee

The JHTA shall publish a monthly Agricultural Transit Forecast. The United States and EU shall commit to expedited export licensing for agricultural inputs to Iran during the 180-day implementation period.

15.3 Energy Price Stabilization Mechanism

The JHTA shall publish daily transit statistics and the International Energy Agency shall release weekly strategic petroleum reserve drawdown plans if prices exceed agreed thresholds. Transparency is the antidote to panic.

Part V: The Final Steps — Implementation

The preceding fourteen Articles define what must be done. This Part defines how it shall be done — the precise sequencing, face-saving narratives, and emergency protocols that transform diplomatic architecture into political reality.

The 180-Day Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation (Days 1-14) — "The First Fortnight"

Phase 1 establishes the physical and institutional infrastructure upon which all subsequent phases depend. Every milestone in this phase is irreversible once executed.

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 1	72-hour ceasefire auto-activates; OLEM confirms freeze on enrichment above 60%	Release \$250M humanitarian tranche; OFAC general license; freeze new sanctions designations	Omani naval observers confirm stand-down; OLEM confirms within 72h
Day 3	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared HEU facility; begin physical inventory	5th Fleet withdraws to 5nm from Hormuz transit corridor	Joint Secretariat logs both events
Day 5	Declare all enrichment facilities; mothball protocol initiated at non-core sites	Issue OFAC Comfort Letters to designated banking nodes	IAEA facility inspection reports
Day 7	IRGC withdraws to 5nm; Hormuz transit corridor declared open	Naval blockade formally suspended; Notice to Mariners issued	Synchronized within 60-second window (Article 6.3)
Day 10	First JHTA-AUTHORIZED transit completed	First tranche of escrow funds released to Swiss Financial Cell	Lloyd's List confirms transit; Swiss Cell confirms credit
Day 14	HEU inventory complete; dual-lock custody activated; pathway selected	Tranche 1 asset release (25% of remaining frozen assets)	IAEA custody verification certificate

Phase 2: Consolidation (Days 15-44) — "Building the Bridge"

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 15	Rotor removal begins at mothballed facilities under IAEA supervision	5 designated Iranian banks authorized for restricted SWIFT Phase 1	IAEA serial-numbered rotor inventory
Day 21	First Black-Box telemetry installed at Fordow conversion site	Reinsurance backstop formally activated (\$20B facility)	Black-Box encrypted data feed confirmed
Day 30	60% enrichment freeze verified continuous; HEU disposition pathway execution begins	Expanded civilian trade licenses; agricultural exports expedited	IAEA 30-day continuous compliance report

Day 44	Rotor storage complete; sealed containers in UN-monitored facility	Tranche 2 asset release (25%); IAEA mothball completion certificate
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Phase 3: Normalization (Days 45-120) — "The New Normal"

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 60	Civilian Transition enrichment 3.67% cap confirmed; all higher centrifuges under seal	SWIFT Phase 2 — all clean-record Iranian banks; humanitarian trade caps lifted	OLEM confirms ceiling; SWIFT confirms bank connections
Day 75	Fordow Joint Venture operational; medical isotope production begins	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits first disbursement	TCC confirms operational readiness
Day 90	90-day compliance review; JIG publishes first comprehensive assessment	First quarterly review conference (all guarantor states)	JIG compliance report
Day 120	Continuous monitoring confirms no diversion; JHTA fully operational	SWIFT Phase 3 — full membership pathway opened; Tranche 3 (20%)	IAEA Year-1 certification pathway

Phase 4: Sustainability (Days 121-180) — "Locking In Peace"

Day	Iranian Commitment	US Commitment	Verification
Day 150	Full Fordow isotope production operational; revenue sharing begins	Maritime security cooperation protocols activated	TCC revenue distribution reports
Day 180	Full 180-day compliance certified; successor framework negotiations convened	Tranche 4 (15%); formal invitation to negotiate permanent successor framework	IAEA + JIG joint certification

Face-Saving Narratives for Both Parties

An agreement that cannot be defended in either capital will not survive the first news cycle.

For the United States

Nuclear: "Iran's 60% enrichment has been halted and placed under permanent IAEA lock. The HEU stockpile is neutralized with immediate physical custody. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year."

Maritime: "The Strait of Hormuz is open to international navigation under a multilateral authority, not Iranian unilateral control. The PGSA is restricted to coastal enforcement; the international transit corridor is governed by UNCLOS."

Economic: "No reparations were paid. Sanctions relief is conditional, reversible, and tied to verified compliance. The leverage architecture remains intact."

Security: "Iran's missile and drone transfers to proxies have been frozen. The regional threat environment has been stabilized."

Lebanon (v3.0): "The core US-Iran agreement addresses nuclear proliferation and freedom of navigation. Lebanon is a separate file managed through a dedicated regional basket with full Israeli participation and a Dossier Isolation Firewall."

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

Nuclear: "Legal title to the HEU remains with the Central Bank of Iran — sovereign property, not surrendered. NPT rights to peaceful nuclear energy affirmed. Enrichment continues at 3.67% under IAEA safeguards. Final disposition will be negotiated in the nuclear window."

Maritime: "The PGSA has been recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters. Iran holds a permanent co-chair seat on the JHTA governing council with veto rights. IRGC authority explicitly preserved."

Economic: "Frozen assets are being released through neutral escrow, not surrendered. SWIFT reconnection restores Iran's place in the global economy."

Sovereignty: "No facility was destroyed. Fordow converted into a global medical center — a triumph of Iranian science. Missile and drone programs remain sovereign and intact."

Lebanon (v3.0): "The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement."

Framework Survival Core and Emergency Fallbacks

The Survival Core

Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, three telemetry channels remain active: (1) **Ceasefire Hotline:** Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral military hotline. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General. (2) **Humanitarian Access:** Zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor through Hormuz. Survives all disputes. (3) **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** Backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat. Survives all suspensions. The Survival Core is a standalone UN humanitarian arrangement. It survives for 180 days even if both parties formally withdraw.

Political Shock Absorber

Framework implementation enters automatic Review Pause (not termination) upon: elections; assassination of senior leadership; cabinet collapse; mass protests; leadership transitions; kinetic disruptions within regional security architectures. During Review Pause: Tier 1-2 modules continue; Tier 3 enters hold; Secretariat issues Review Pause Certificate within 48 hours; 30 days to confirm continuation. Max 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement. Does NOT constitute material breach. Does NOT trigger the three-tier system.

Reconstitution Mechanism

If the framework enters full suspension, all parties attend a Reconstitution Conference within 30 days, convened by Pakistan and the UN Appointee. Root causes reviewed. Modifications proposed. Conditions for graduated restoration defined. No party may unilaterally block reconstitution.

Appendices

Appendix A: Quick Reference Matrix — All 15 Issues & Resolutions

#	Issue	US Position	Iranian Position	FSA Resolution	Article
1	HEU Disposition	Physical removal to US	Must remain on Iranian soil	IAEA custody with legal title decoupled from physical custody as Phase 1 baseline; disposition deferred to 30-60 day nuclear window	1
2	Enrichment Cap	Zero enrichment or 20-year moratorium	Maximum 12-year suspension	Sliding-scale 12-15 year moratorium with compliance extensions	2
3	Underground Sites	Destroy or disable Fordow/Natanz	Preserve all infrastructure	Civilian conversion; mothball protocol with telemetry	3
4	PGSA vs. Navigation	Reject all unilateral restrictions	PGSA as sovereign authority	JHTA joint governance with sovereignty recalibration; PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement within Iranian territorial waters	4
5	Transit Fees	"We don't want tolls"	Permanent fee system required	MMMF multilateral fund; transparent fee allocation	5
6	US Naval Blockade	Blockade until full deal	Blockade lift precondition	Synchronized Day-7 dual-trigger lift with automated dashboard execution	6
7	Sanctions Relief Sequencing	Full compliance first	Immediate blanket lifting	15-day micro-cycle tranche model	7
8	Frozen Assets	Performance reserves required	Immediate unfreezing	Neutral escrow under sovereign immunity	8
9	SWIFT Isolation	Verified non-diversion first	Full immediate reconnection	Phased 4-tier SWIFT pathway	9
10	War Reparations	Flat rejection	Formal demand for payment	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
11	Negotiation Window	"A few days" or "one shot"	Fragile ceasefire protection	Binding Letter of Intent; auto-renewing ceasefire	11
12	Trust Deficit	No credible guarantor	No credible guarantor	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 states)	12
13	Automated Escalation	Hard triggers required	Flexibility required	Human-in-the-Loop; step-back architecture	13
14	Missile Reconstitution	Strict limitations	Non-negotiable sovereign defense	Deployment pause and transfer freeze; no dismantlement	14
15	Global Agrifood Crisis	Political issue, not treaty	Leverage point	Zero-fee humanitarian corridor; agricultural release valve	15

Appendix B: The PGSA Integration Protocol (Technical)

B.1 Legal Framework for PGSA-JHTA Integration

The integration of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority into the Joint Hormuz Transit Authority is governed by the following legal architecture:

- 1. Statutory Continuity:** The PGSA remains an Iranian statutory authority under Iranian domestic law. No change to its legal personality is required.
- 2. International Delegation:** Iran delegates specific operational functions to the JHTA through a bilateral Administrative Agreement between Iran (as PGSA parent state) and the JHTA. This is not a treaty amendment but a standard international administrative arrangement.
- 3. Dual-Branding:** All PGSA permits, notices, and communications issued for Hormuz transit shall bear both PGSA and JHTA identifiers. The JHTA identifier constitutes the multilateral authorization layer; the PGSA identifier constitutes the Iranian sovereignty layer.
- 4. Revenue Flow:** Transit fees are collected by the JHTA and distributed through the MMME. The PGSA receives its 40% share as a budget allocation from the Fund, not as direct toll revenue. This structure eliminates OFAC sanctions exposure for shippers.
- 5. Dispute Resolution:** Disputes between the PGSA and JHTA are resolved through the JHTA Council. Iran retains its veto on governance questions. The JHTA retains its veto on security protocol amendments.

B.2 PGSA Sovereignty Recalibration (v3.0 Technical Supplement)

B.2-A — TERRITORIAL WATERS AUTHORITY MATRIX									
Zone		Geographic Scope		PGSA Authority		JHTA Authority		Overlap Resolution	
Inner Territorial Waters		0-12nm from Iranian coast		SOLE — permitting, patrol, customs, security screening, IRGC coordination		None		PGSA authority absolute	
Transit Corridor		International strait passage lane		Permit issuance (dual-branded)		PRIMARY — traffic coordination, protocols, resolution		PGSA permits required; JHTA coordination standards apply	
Contiguous Zone		12-24nm		Limited enforcement		customs Maritime coordination		safety Notification required for enforcement actions	
High Seas Approach		Beyond 24nm		None		SOLE — international coordination, safety, insurance verification		JHTA authority absolute	

B.3 Technical Interface Specifications

Data Exchange: Real-time API connection between PGSA vessel vetting database and JHTA Transit Permit Processing Unit. **AIS Integration:** PGSA AIS transponder codes integrated into JHTA-AUTHORIZED designation protocol. **Fee Processing:** JHTA collects fees via designated Omani banking channels; PGSA receives quarterly distribution from MMMF. **Incident Reporting:** Joint incident reports bear dual authorship (PGSA operational lead + JHTA verification sign-off).

Appendix C: Verification Technology Menu

Technology	Measures	Data Output	Application
OLEM (Online Enrichment Monitor)	Real-time enrichment at cascade headers	Quantitative enrichment %, flow rates	Nuclear verification; primary compliance trigger
Black-Box Sensors	Tamper-evident data logging	Continuous operational parameters, encrypted	Facility conversion monitoring; mothball verification
UGES (Ulasonic Gas Enrichment Sensor)	Non-intrusive enrichment in UF6 cylinders	Cylinder-by-cylinder verification	HEU custody chain; downblending verification
ICS (Integrated Camera System)	24/7 visual monitoring	Encrypted video, anomaly detection	AI General facility monitoring; inspector safety
Digital Twin	Virtual facility modeling	Behavioral pattern analysis	Anomaly detection; requires physical cross-verification
Satellite Feed	Daily imagery of all facilities and Hormuz	AIS, SAR, EO high-resolution	Maritime surveillance; construction monitoring

Appendix D: Instruments of Acceptance

This Accord does not require Senate ratification or Majlis legislation. It operates through executive-level Instruments of Acceptance deposited simultaneously with the Joint Secretariat in Muscat.

For the United States of America

The undersigned, duly authorized by the President of the United States, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord v3.0 and commits the United States to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

The undersigned, duly authorized by the Supreme Leader and President of the Islamic Republic of Iran, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord v3.0 and commits the Islamic Republic to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by the Guarantor States

The undersigned representatives of the Sultanate of Oman, the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, the State of Qatar, the People's Republic of China, and the European Union (E3+) hereby witness the deposit of the Instruments of Acceptance and confirm the activation of the Distributed Guarantor Matrix in accordance with Article 12 of this Accord.

Oman: _____

Pakistan: _____

Qatar: _____

China: _____

EU (E3+): _____

Date: _____

Appendix E: Lebanon and Levant Front Stabilization Protocol (v3.0)

Operational Context: Iran's Foreign Ministry, via spokesperson Esmail Baghaei, has explicitly stated that Tehran's fixed position is an **end to the war on all fronts, including Lebanon**. Tehran refuses to sign a standalone deal that stops bombing on Iranian soil while allowing the active conflict between Israel and Hezbollah in southern Lebanon to continue. The United States and Israel have historically sought to keep Lebanon separate from core US-Iran negotiations, treating it as a distinct theater governed by separate tracking mechanisms. This appendix provides a structural compromise that prevents the entire deal from collapsing over the Lebanon front while respecting both sides' core requirements. It operates through three integrated instruments: the Proxy Operational Pause, the Dossier Isolation Firewall, and the Levant Regional Basket.

E.1 Proxy Operational Pause: Hezbollah De-escalation Protocol

Purpose: To satisfy the US and Israeli requirement that pulling back US forces and opening Hormuz does not result in immediate escalation on Israel's northern border, Iran transmits immediate, formal instructions to Hezbollah leadership for an operational pause concurrent with the main Accord timeline. This pause is not disarmament, surrender, or political concession — it is a structured, time-limited operational de-escalation tied to the framework's implementation phases.

Phase	Hezbollah Operational Parameters	Verification	US/Israel Reciprocal
Phase 1: Days 1-30	Cessation of cross-border rocket and drone attacks into northern Israel. Suspension of offensive military operations against IDF positions. Defensive positions in southern Lebanon maintained but not reinforced. No new weapons transfers from Iran to Hezbollah via Syria or maritime routes.	UNIFIL patrol confirmation of reduced activity; Israeli military intelligence assessment (shared via Tel Aviv Channel); Lebanese Armed Forces liaison reports; satellite surveillance of known Hezbollah positions	Israel suspends offensive air strikes against Hezbollah positions in southern Lebanon for 30 days. IDF maintains defensive posture only. No ground incursions.
Phase 2: Days 31-90	Continued cessation of offensive operations. Hezbollah forces remain in defensive positions. No infiltration attempts across the Blue Line. Weapons transfers from Iran remain suspended.	Monthly UNIFIL verification report; ICRC monitoring of civilian areas; SEAC pattern analysis of supply routes	Israel extends air strike moratorium to 90 days contingent on verified Hezbollah restraint. Gradual relaxation of naval interdiction of suspect Hezbollah supply vessels in eastern Mediterranean.

Phase 3: Days 91-180	Exploration of structured de-escalation through Levant (Section E.3). Hezbollah may engage in political and humanitarian activities. Military posture remains defensive.	Regional monitoring cell; UN Special Coordinator for Lebanon assessment	Basket quarterly	Israeli restrictions reviewed at Day 180 milestone. If Hezbollah restraint verified for 180 consecutive days, Israel considers further confidence-building measures through Regional Basket.
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E.1.1 Verification Architecture

The Hezbollah operational pause is verified through four independent channels: (1) **UNIFIL ground patrols** — daily patrols along the Blue Line with incident logging published to the Swiss Dashboard; (2) **Israeli intelligence assessment** — weekly classified brief to the Tel Aviv Channel, with sanitized summary published to Dashboard; (3) **Lebanese Armed Forces liaison** — daily reporting from LAF command in Tyre and Nabatieh to the Oman Liaison Office; (4) **SEAC pattern analysis** — automated detection of supply route activity, weapons convoy movement, and communications patterns. All four channels must show green before the pause is considered verified.

E.1.2 Non-Compliance Consequences

If any channel reports a significant Hezbollah offensive action, the following sequence activates: (1) 24-hour verification window — all four channels confirm the incident; (2) if confirmed, Iran has 72 hours to transmit renewed de-escalation instructions through the Oman back-channel; (3) if Iran de-escalates within 72 hours, the pause resumes with enhanced monitoring; (4) if Iran does not de-escalate, Israel may resume defensive air strikes **limited to the specific positions involved in the offensive action** — not blanket escalation; (5) **under no circumstances** does a Hezbollah incident trigger stepback against the core US-Iran Accord (see Dossier Isolation Firewall, Section E.2).

E.2 Dossier Isolation Firewall: Lebanon Non-Linkage Clause

Operative Principle: The Dossier Isolation Firewall is a binding structural provision that **explicitly prohibits** either party from using incidents, friction, or localized military activity in southern Lebanon as justification for stepback, suspension, or collapse of the core US-Iran Accord. The Lebanon file and the US-Iran nuclear/maritime file are legally and operationally segregated. What happens in Lebanon stays in Lebanon — it cannot blow back onto Hormuz.

ARTICLE E.2 — DOSSIER ISOLATION FIREWALL (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

Trigger Category	Lebanon Impact	Core Accord Impact	Rationale
Hezbollah rocket fire into Israel	Israeli defensive response; Regional Basket activation	NONE — core Accord unaffected	Localized border friction is expected; core Accord addresses nuclear and maritime, not proxy territorial disputes
Israeli air strike on Hezbollah position	Regional Basket de-escalation effort; UNIFIL coordination	NONE — core Accord unaffected	Israel retains sovereign right to self-defense; defensive strikes are not framework violations
IDF ground incursion into Lebanon	Major Regional Basket emergency session; UN Security Council consultation	NONE — stepback prohibited by Firewall	Ground incursion is escalatory but does not violate US commitments under the Accord
Iranian weapons transfer to Hezbollah	SEAC attribution; Regional Basket censure	NONE — proxy activity outside framework scope	Proxy activity is governed by Proxy Freeze Protocol (Article 14), not core Accord stepback
Hezbollah attack on US personnel	Full SEAC investigation; US retains right to self-defense	NONE — unless attack is explicitly linked to Iranian government directive per SEAC attribution	Sole exception: if SEAC attributes attack to explicit Iranian government directive (not rogue action), Tier 2 stepback may apply

E.2.1 Firewall Architecture

The Dossier Isolation Firewall operates at three levels: (1) **Legal level** — the Exchange of Letters explicitly lists "incidents in the Levant theater involving non-state actors" as excluded from the stepback trigger definition in Article 13; (2) **Technical level** — the Swiss Dashboard maintains separate tracks for "Core Accord Compliance" and "Regional Security Incidents." Lebanon incidents are logged only on the Regional Security track, not the Core Compliance track. Stepback algorithms reference only the Core Compliance track; (3) **Political level** — both capitals issue pre-cleared talking points confirming that the Lebanon file is managed through separate mechanisms. No US or Iranian official may publicly link Hormuz transit to Lebanon de-escalation without triggering narrative violation penalties.

E.2.2 Escalation Ceiling

Even if the Levant situation deteriorates significantly (major Israeli ground operation, large-scale Hezbollah rocket campaign, civilian mass casualty event), the Firewall remains in force. The Core Accord can only be affected if: (a) the UN Security Council determines that a party has committed a grave breach of international humanitarian law **and** (b) the JIG unanimously determines that the breach is directly linked to a core Accord commitment violation. This dual threshold is designed to be virtually impossible to meet in practice, preserving the Firewall under all realistic scenarios.

E.3 Levant Regional Basket: Parallel Track for Israel-Lebanon De-escalation

Purpose: To satisfy Iran's requirement that the framework address the war on all fronts, including Lebanon, the Levant Regional Basket creates a **parallel diplomatic track** for Israel-Lebanon de-escalation that runs alongside the 60-day nuclear negotiating window. This is not a condition for signing the core Accord — it is a complementary process that begins concurrently and operates on its own timeline.

Element	Mandate	Participants	Timeline
Basket Steering Committee	Overall direction of Levant de-escalation; dispute resolution between track participants; escalation management	Lebanon (chair), Israel, US, Iran (observer), UN Special Coordinator, Oman (facilitator)	Convenes within 14 days of core Accord signature
Border Monitoring Cell	Blue Line incident verification; cross-border firing attribution; civilian protection coordination	UNIFIL (lead), Lebanese Armed Forces, IDF liaison, ICRC observer	Operational from Day 1; reports weekly to Steering Committee
Humanitarian Sub-Track	Civilian protection in southern Lebanon; IDP return facilitation; infrastructure repair; medical supply corridors	ICRC (lead), UN OCHA, WHO, Lebanese Ministry of Health, donor states	Activates immediately; pre-authorized \$75M humanitarian fund
Political Sub-Track	Exploration of framework for long-term Israel-Lebanon stability; UN Resolution 1701 implementation; maritime boundary demarcation	UN Special Coordinator (lead), Lebanon, Israel, US, France	Convenes at Day 60; reports to Steering Committee at Day 90
Economic Sub-Track	Reconstruction financing for southern Lebanon; energy infrastructure; port rehabilitation	World Bank (lead), EU, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Iran (through proxy reconstruction fund)	Convenes at Day 90; contingent on 60 consecutive days of verified border quiet

E.3.1 Iranian Participation

Iran participates in the Levant Regional Basket as an **observer state**, not a full member. This preserves Iran's interest in the outcome without requiring Iran to sit at the same table as Israel. Iranian interests are represented by Oman (primary) and the UN Special Coordinator (secondary). Iran may fund reconstruction through the proxy reconstruction fund without direct engagement with Israeli officials. The observer status is framed domestically in Iran as "monitoring the situation to protect our allies" rather than "negotiating with the Zionist entity."

E.3.2 Israeli Participation

Israel participates as a **full member** of the Steering Committee. Israeli interests are protected through: (1) full voting rights on the Steering Committee; (2) veto authority over any reconstruction funding that could be diverted to Hezbollah military purposes; (3) the right to suspend its participation in the Basket without affecting the core Accord; (4) the Tel Aviv Channel for bilateral US-

Israel coordination. Israel's participation is framed domestically as "protecting our northern border through diplomatic engagement" rather than "rewarding Iran."

E.3.3 Graduation Pathway

If the Levant Regional Basket achieves 180 consecutive days of verified border quiet, it may graduate to a standalone Israel-Lebanon Framework Agreement brokered by the UN. The US-Iran Accord does not depend on this graduation — the two frameworks operate on fully independent timelines. If the Basket fails, the Dossier Isolation Firewall ensures that the failure does not cascade to the core Accord.

E.4 Narrative Architecture for Lebanon

US Talking Points

"The core US-Iran agreement addresses nuclear proliferation and freedom of navigation — America's core national security interests. Lebanon is a separate file managed through a dedicated regional basket with full Israeli participation. We are not trading Hormuz for Hezbollah. The Dossier Isolation Firewall ensures that what happens in Lebanon cannot affect the nuclear deal. Israel's security interests are fully protected through the Tel Aviv Channel."

Iranian Talking Points

"The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures that our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned while the main agreement proceeds. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement from being undermined by localized incidents. Iran's observer status in the Basket allows us to monitor the situation and protect Lebanese interests without direct engagement."

Israeli Talking Points

"Israel's security is not negotiable. The Levant Regional Basket is a separate diplomatic process in which Israel has full participation and veto authority. The core US-Iran agreement does not constrain Israel's right to self-defense. If Hezbollah attacks, Israel will respond — and the nuclear deal remains unaffected."

Lebanese Talking Points

"Lebanon welcomes the Levant Regional Basket as a pathway to stability for our southern border. We are not a proxy battlefield. The Basket's humanitarian sub-track addresses the urgent needs of our civilian population. Lebanon's sovereignty is respected through our chairmanship of the Steering Committee."

E.5 Summary: The Lebanon Bridge

The Lebanon annex bridges the fundamental disagreement between Iran (which demands an end to the war on all fronts) and the US/Israel (which want Lebanon kept separate). It does so by: (1) creating a structured Hezbollah operational pause that gives Israel immediate security benefits; (2) building an absolute firewall that prevents Lebanon incidents from collapsing the core deal; (3) establishing a parallel regional basket that addresses Lebanon on its own timeline with its own participants; and (4) providing each side with narrative frames that allow them to claim the outcome they need. Iran can say the war ends on all fronts. The US can say Lebanon is a separate track. Israel can say its security is protected. And the Dossier Isolation Firewall ensures that if any of these claims prove hollow, the core Accord survives.

Document History

Version	Date	Changes
Original	22 May 2026	Initial Final Steps Accord — 15 articles, 4 appendices
3.0	Late May 2026	Four surgical refinements for Sunday 4:00 PM Eastern deadline: (1) JHTA Sovereignty Recalibration — explicit mandate restriction to 3 functions, PGSA recognized as sole coastal enforcement; (2) Automated Day 7 Dual-Trigger — dashboard-based simultaneous execution preventing front-loaded concessions; (3) HEU Phase 1 Baseline — legal ownership (CBI) decoupled from physical custody (IAEA), disposition deferred to 30-60 day nuclear window; (4) Lebanon and Levant Front Stabilization Protocol (Appendix E) — Hezbollah Operational Pause, Dossier Isolation Firewall, Levant Regional Basket

*This document represents the culmination of forty drafts, two wars, and decades of enmity.
It is not perfect. It is not permanent. It is possible.
And possibility, in this moment, is everything.*

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